

Release 1.0

- Cannon Fodder -

Core Field Manual



SOLDIER'S HANDBOOK

“To cannon, all men are equal”
- Napoleon Bonaparte

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Contact CannonFodderRPG@gmail.com for inquiries.

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Author

Andrew Moffatt

Designers

Stephen Rock Tyler Lyman Gabriel Eskew
Chase Edwards Marco Romagna

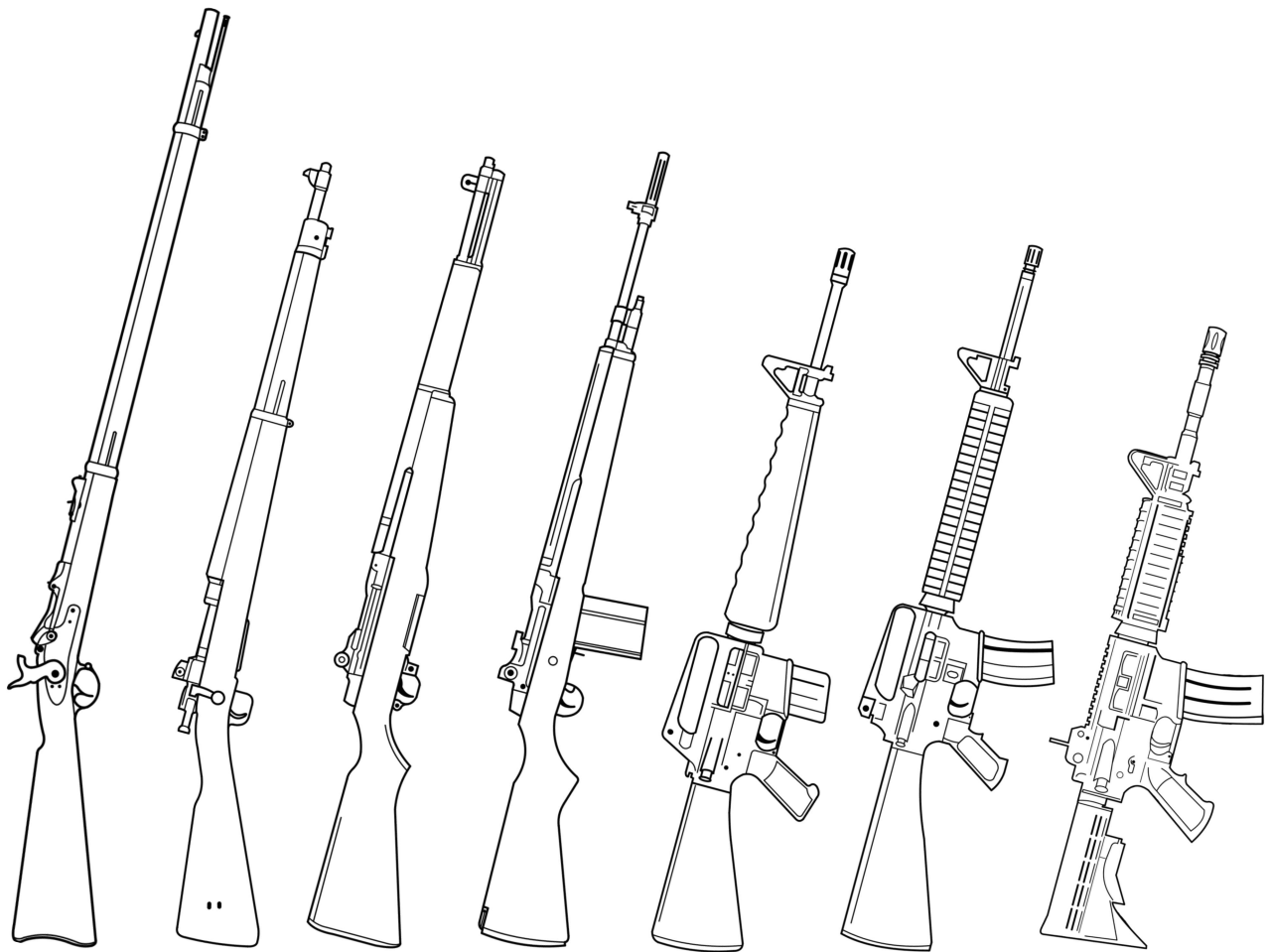
Illustrators

Carolina Inkote Jacob McConnell Derrek Fan

Collaborators

Nick Turcios Ryan Tran Nirupam Saha
Grant Klos Daniela Eskew Ben Runkle
Haider Allawi Tristan Bellawala

“Real men despise battle,
but will never run from it.”
- George Washington



Core Field Manual

Part 1 Introduction



Preface

Congratulations Soldier! You will soon be embarking on an epic journey within the Cannon Fodder system. From the trenches of the Somme, to the jungles of Vietnam, Cannon Fodder is the perfect canvas for any late 19th to modern 21st century firearm action. You may be tossed into a tragic last stand, a historic battle, a thrilling game of espionage, or even something more fantastical. As long as there's guns-a-plenty, Cannon Fodder will help you navigate these adventures.

Cannon Fodder Overview

Cannon Fodder is a setting agnostic, gun-centric, tabletop, role-playing game that employs collaborative storytelling to create exciting adventures in a shared imaginary world. One person takes on the role of the Game Master (GM), who will act as storyteller and guide. The other players act as their own characters, each armed with unique abilities, weapons, backgrounds, and personalities. The game unfolds as the GM presents a world with challenges and scenarios that the players must respond to by describing their characters' actions, decisions, and interactions. For difficult tasks, the outcome is determined by dice, adding an element of suspense through randomness. To survive, players must use their creativity and strategy to navigate the GM's challenges, resulting in a dynamic experience where the possibilities are limited only by the imagination.

Field Manual Scope

This Field Manual serves as a structured guide for the both players and GM during your storytelling adventure. Its primary purpose is to ensure everyone has a clear and consistent understanding of how Cannon Fodder is played. However, the GM has ultimate say on how their game unfolds, even if it directly contradicts the rules outlined here.

Battlefield Terminology

This section is intended for general referencing. While a first-time reader is missing context, it is important to at least be aware of these terms and acronyms.

GM — The “Game Master” is the narrative steward for the players.

PC — “Player Character” refers to characters that are controlled by any player who is not the GM.

NPC — “Non-Player Character” refers to characters controlled by the GM.

Action — A single interaction with the game world by a character. Actions include but are not limited to shooting, moving, and performing Checks.

Turn — A set of two consecutive Actions.

Round — The complete cycle of every player and NPC’s Turns starting from the beginning of the initiative order.

Check — An Action that is not trivial to accomplish and is resolved by rolling 1d20 + applicable Ability Score and any other special modifiers. Any roll not using a d20 or Ability Score is not considered a Check.

DC — “Difficulty of Completion” is a minimum value that a Check must make for a task to succeed.

Modifier — A value that is added or subtracted from a Check.

Attack — A special Check where you attempt to shoot, Strike, or Grapple a target.

Initiative — The order in which turns are taken within a round, determined by a Reflex Check at the start of combat (see [Initiative](#)).

HP — “Health Points” or “Hit Points” are a measure of physical condition where, the lower its value, the closer to death you are.

To-Hit — The Attack roll a ranged weapon makes to determine if it hits the target.

Base Attack — A gun's Base Attack is labeled as Damage Single Shot, Damage Burst, or Damage Auto and represents the primary attack of your Action.

Extra Attack — Extra Attacks are additional bullets you can shoot in your Action to squeeze out more damage per attack.

Rounding — All rounding grants the upper hand to the rounder unless otherwise specified; i.e. rounding down penalties while rounding up bonuses.

Ally — A PC or NPC that is cooperating with you and that you both agree are Allies at that moment.

Enemy — Any PC or NPC you choose that isn't yourself or one of your Allies

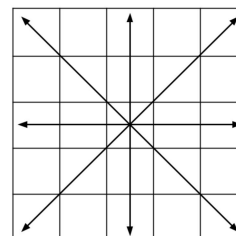
Natural — The value of a dice roll before any modifiers, so a "natural" 20 is rolling a 20 on the die itself.

Line of Sight — The target is within Line of Sight if you are aware of them and they do not have Full Cover (see [Stances & Visibility](#)).

Advantage — A roll "with advantage" means you roll the dice twice and use the highest value of the two. Advantage can stack, meaning rolling with "double advantage" requires three die rolls taking the highest of the triplet.

Disadvantage — Similar to Advantage except you take the lowest value of the dice rolled. Each Disadvantage will cancel out an Advantage.

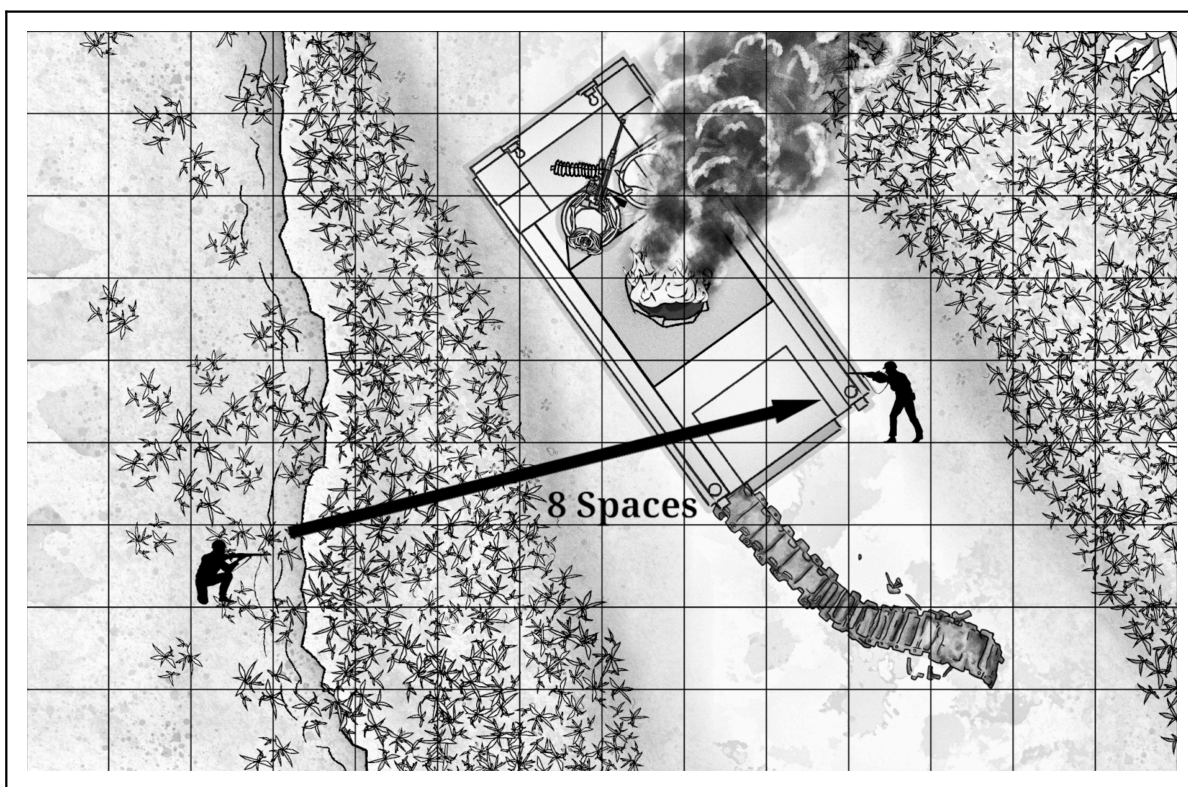
Cardinal Direction — The primary directions of a compass; these are lines extended from the character at 45° increments and are used for a variety of purposes.



Map — A map is a visual aid provided by the GM. Cannon Fodder uses maps made up of square grids to represent physical locations. The 2D or 3D grids are referred to as Spaces, but Spaces can also represent linear distance.

Ranges — Below are the standard ranges, using Spaces as a unit of measurement. Spaces represent a real-life dimension between 5 feet and 5 yards and measuring distance follows the same rules as Movement where diagonals count as 1 Space.

Point Blank	PB	(0-1 Spaces)	In the same room or at melee range
Close	CL	(2-3 Spaces)	Across a hallway
Short	SR	(4-6 Spaces)	Down a street
Medium	MD	(7-10 Spaces)	Down the length of a block
Far	FR	(11-20 Spaces)	The normal firefight range
Distant	DT	(21-60 Spaces)	Close to or beyond visual range
Extreme	EX	(61-100 Spaces)	Well beyond visual range



(Example Map)

“Here they found real war, but
they were not ready for it.”
- Georgy Zhukov

